RCOC GENERAL APPLICATION QUESTIONNAIRE

1. **Name of Applicant**
IABA Research & Education Foundation

2. **Organizational Structure**
Corporation – Nonprofit (501(c)(3))

3. **Name of Primary Contact**
Dr. Lori Ann Dotson

4. **Email of Primary Contact**
[redacted]

5. **Telephone Number of Primary Contact**
[redacted]

6. **Address**
[redacted]

7. Website
https://iaba.foundation

8. Board Representation and Demographics
The IABA Research and Education Foundation is a nonprofit organization and therefore does not have owners. The organization is governed by a volunteer board of directors that advises the Founder and Chief Executive Officer.

Members of the board bring diverse perspectives including professional expertise in disability services, psychology, social work, education, and community advocacy. Some board members self-identify as neurodivergent and others bring lived experience as parent advocates of children and adults with intellectual and developmental disabilities. Disclosure of disability status or demographic identity is voluntary and is not formally collected by the Foundation as a matter of policy. The board is currently in its first cycle of development and continues to grow. As the board expands, the Foundation is actively seeking to recruit additional members with lived experience of disability and individuals from diverse communities to strengthen representation and guidance in the organization's work.

9. Experience

a. Working with persons with intellectual or developmental disabilities

Through the work of the Institute for Applied Behavior Analysis and the IABA Research and Education Foundation, our team has decades of experience supporting individuals with intellectual and developmental disabilities across a wide range of service settings. These efforts have included supported employment, supported living, behavioral consultation, family support, and community integration services. IABA has partnered with regional centers throughout California, including the Regional Center of Orange County, to support individuals and families in developing person-centered plans, accessing services, and building meaningful lives in their communities.

b. Working with underserved, unserved, or BIPOC communities

The Foundation's work prioritizes accessibility and inclusion for individuals and families from diverse cultural and linguistic backgrounds. Through professional training, community education, and service consultation, IABA and the Foundation have worked with communities that have historically experienced barriers to accessing disability services, including culturally and linguistically diverse families. Training initiatives emphasize culturally responsive practices, family-centered engagement, and the use of interpreters and translated materials to ensure meaningful participation.

c. Community outreach, training, and resource development

The Institute for Applied Behavior Analysis has provided training in positive behavioral practices, person-centered planning, and community integration to tens of thousands of professionals worldwide. The IABA Research and Education Foundation builds upon this legacy through educational programs, professional training initiatives, and resource development aimed at strengthening disability service systems. These efforts include development of training curricula, professional learning opportunities, and educational resources that support practitioners, families, and service systems.

10. Familiarity and Experience

a. Person-centered planning

The Foundation's training programs are grounded in person-centered planning principles, including Personal Futures Planning and related approaches that emphasize listening deeply to individuals, identifying meaningful life goals, and building supports that reflect personal strengths, preferences, and relationships. Core faculty have been directly trained in these approaches through the work of Beth Mount and other leaders in person-centered practice.

b. Self-determination
The training program aligns with the principles of California's Self-Determination Program, including freedom, authority, support, responsibility, and confirmation. Our work emphasizes helping individuals exercise meaningful choice in directing their services and supports while ensuring alignment with regulatory frameworks and service system requirements.

c. Plain language and Universal Design for Learning
Training materials developed by the Foundation are intentionally designed to be accessible and jargon-free. Instruction emphasizes the use of plain language communication and Universal Design for Learning principles so that information is accessible to professionals, family members, and individuals with disabilities. Written materials and presentations are structured to support clarity, comprehension, and meaningful participation.

d. Community resources and the regional center system
The Foundation's work builds upon decades of experience navigating California's developmental services system. Through partnerships with regional centers and community organizations, our team has developed extensive familiarity with service coordination processes, community resource networks, and interdisciplinary collaboration needed to support individuals with intellectual and developmental disabilities.

11. Project Applying For
Advanced Training for Independent Facilitators – Self-Determination Program
Regional Center of Orange County SDP Local Volunteer Advisory Committee

12. Professional References



SPECIFIC APPLICATION QUESTIONNAIRE
Advanced Training for Independent Facilitators
Proposal to the SDP Local Volunteer Advisory Committee –
Regional Center of Orange County

1. **Experience Providing Advanced Training to Independent Facilitator**

The IABA Research and Education Foundation is a nonprofit organization dedicated to advancing education, training, and research that improve the lives of individuals with intellectual and developmental disabilities. The Foundation's mission is to further the work of Gary LaVigna and Thomas Willis, founders of the Institute for Applied Behavior Analysis.

The Foundation is a separate nonprofit entity governed by a volunteer board of directors that advises the Founder and Chief Executive Officer. As a nonprofit organization, the Foundation does not have owners.
The Institute for Applied Behavior Analysis is a privately owned organization founded by the same leadership. While the Foundation and the Institute are separate legal entities, the Foundation benefits from longstanding professional relationships, training expertise, and field leadership developed through the Institute's decades of service within California's developmental services system and internationally.
Through this relationship, the Foundation is able to draw upon extensive experience in professional training, person-centered practices, supported living and employment, and non-aversive approaches to behavior support.

The Institute for Applied Behavior Analysis Research and Education Foundation develops professional education that advances person-centered, non-aversive supports for individuals with intellectual and developmental disabilities. The Foundation's work builds upon the decades-long leadership of the Institute for Applied Behavior Analysis (IABA), whose training programs have reached tens of thousands of professionals worldwide including regional center staff, service providers, clinicians, educators, and lived experience experts.

IABA has worked extensively within California's developmental services system and has partnered with regional centers across the state, including the Regional Center of Orange County. These collaborations have involved consultation, professional training, and service development focused on supported employment, supported living, respite, community integration, and positive behavioral practices.

Training approaches are informed by the Multi-Element Behavior Support (MEBS)

model developed through IABA's work, which emphasizes constructional approaches that build meaningful behavioral repertoires with the aim of improvement in quality of life. This model has been analyzed within a human rights framework that emphasizes participation, empowerment, and dignity in service delivery (Doody, 2009), characteristics closely aligned with self-determination. These approaches closely align with the responsibilities of Independent Facilitators within the Self-Determination Program, including facilitating person-centered planning, identifying community resources, assisting with spending plan development, and advocating for individuals participating in the program.

2. Familiarity with RCOC Service Standards, DDS Directives, HCBS Requirements, and the Lanterman Act

Through longstanding work in California's developmental services system, IABA has developed deep familiarity with regional center service standards, documentation expectations, and interdisciplinary collaboration processes. This experience includes decades of work with the Regional Center of Orange County and other regional centers throughout the state.

At the statewide level, IABA has also contributed to initiatives with the California Department of Developmental Services, including participation in the development of service codes and system-wide training initiatives. IABA's research and applied clinical expertise is referenced in the *DDS Guidelines for the Use of Restraint or Containment in Enhanced Behavioral Supports Homes*, reflecting the organization's contributions to ethical and non-aversive practices within California's developmental services system.

IABA's work has always been grounded in the rights framework established by the Lanterman Developmental Disabilities Services Act, which guarantees individuals with developmental disabilities the right to services and supports that enable them to live independent and productive lives in the community. Since its inception in California, IABA has been a leader in supported employment and supported living services that promote community integration and meaningful participation in society.

IABA has also assisted individuals and provider organizations in accessing and maintaining Home and Community-Based Services waivers. These efforts require alignment with federal HCBS standards related to community integration, person-centered planning, and individual choice.

This knowledge is further strengthened by lived experience. Dr. Lori Ann Dotson, the proposed lead for this project, parented a child with profound disabilities receiving services through California's developmental services system, including HCBS-related supports. This lived perspective is in addition to the organization's professional experience supporting individuals and families navigating these systems.

All project activities and reporting will be completed prior to the December 31, 2026 deadline.

3. Training Approach: Person-Centered Planning and the RCOC Review Process
The proposed training program focuses on strengthening Independent Facilitators' ability to translate person-centered values into practical service planning and effective collaboration with regional center systems.

Training methods draw upon the tradition of Personal Futures Planning developed by Beth Mount, emphasizing deep listening, identification of meaningful life goals, and development of supports that reflect each individual's strengths, preferences, and relationships (Mount, 2000). Participants will learn to facilitate person-centered conversations, identify community resources, translate goals into actionable supports, and develop spending plans aligned with desired life outcomes. Core Foundation faculty have been directly trained and mentored by Dr. Mount.

The curriculum will also address practical strategies for working with the Regional Center of Orange County (RCOC) review process, including documentation expectations, alignment with service standards, and collaboration with interdisciplinary planning teams. Case-based learning will allow participants to practice applying these skills to real-world situations encountered by Independent Facilitators.

The training is grounded in the five principles of self-determination, freedom, authority, support, responsibility, and confirmation. Participants will explore how these principles guide the Self-Determination Program and how Independent Facilitators can support individuals in exercising meaningful choice while navigating regulatory and system requirements.

To ensure alignment with the priorities outlined in the RFP, the training curriculum will address the following advanced competencies relevant to Independent Facilitators working within the Self-Determination Program:

- Development of Person-Centered Plans that reflect individual goals, preferences, and life outcomes
- Understanding and navigating the RCOC review process
- Application of RCOC service standards in the development of support plans
- Understanding the rights, entitlements, and due process protections outlined in the Lanterman Developmental Disabilities Services Act
- Compliance with Home and Community-Based Services (HCBS) requirements, including community integration and individual choice
- Overview of relevant Department of Developmental Services directives and guidance related to the Self-Determination Program
- Understanding the SDP transition process within RCOC
- Development of advanced SDP budgets and spending plans aligned with person-centered outcomes
- Critical thinking and problem-solving strategies for addressing challenges encountered in SDP implementation
- Strategies for effective advocacy on behalf of participants

- Maintaining ethical practice, professional boundaries, and collaborative relationships with stakeholders

Through a combination of applied learning, case analysis, and facilitated discussion, the training will emphasize practical strategies that Independent Facilitators can immediately apply when supporting individuals participating in the Self-Determination Program.

4. Qualifications of Individuals Responsible for the Project
Dr. Lori Ann Dotson, Chief Knowledge and Learning Officer for the IABA Research and Education Foundation, will lead the training program. Dr. Dotson holds graduate degrees in psychology, business, and education and has completed Leadership Education in Neurodevelopmental and Related Disabilities (LEND) training at the University of California San Diego. This interdisciplinary training emphasized family-centered practice, disability rights, and systems leadership.

Dr. Dotson's work spans research, professional training, and systems development across multiple countries. By the initiation of this project, she will have delivered live professional training on five continents. These experiences strengthen the program's ability to address culturally and linguistically diverse communities.

The project will also benefit from the expertise of Janette Miranda, MSW, whose background in social work and systems coordination provides expertise in community resource navigation, service system collaboration, and family engagement. Ms. Miranda is a native Spanish speaker and contributes valuable insight into culturally responsive service delivery.

Additionally, the Foundation, and the trainees participating in this program, benefit from a diverse advisory board representing multiple disciplines and perspectives including direct professionals, individuals with lived experience of disability, researchers, educators, advocates and community leaders, clinicians in psychology and social work, and our sister disciplines within the helping professions. Although advisory board members will not directly deliver training, they provide important advisement, technical consultation, and problem-solving support when challenges arise during program development and implementation.

The Foundation's mission is to further the work of Drs. Gary LaVigna and Thomas Willis, founders of the Institute for Applied Behavior Analysis, whose contributions to person-centered and non-aversive practices have influenced disability services internationally.

5. Project Timeline
Spring 2026: Curriculum development, alignment with RCOC SDP requirements, and translation of training materials into Spanish.

Summer 2026: Launch of Learning Management System modules and initial training sessions for Independent Facilitators.

Fall 2026: Additional training cohorts offered as needed to accommodate demand, along with continued live instruction and consultation sessions.

Late Fall 2026: Participant feedback collection, evaluation of training outcomes, and preparation of a final summary report.

6. Anticipated Outcomes and Measurement of Success

The training program is designed to strengthen Independent Facilitators' ability to support individuals participating in the Self-Determination Program.

Expected outcomes include increased understanding of SDP policies and processes, improved quality of person-centered planning, stronger skills in navigating regional center review processes, and increased confidence in advocacy and problem solving.

Success will be measured through participant feedback surveys, participation data, and qualitative feedback regarding the usefulness and applicability of training materials. Evaluation results will inform continuous improvement of the program.

7. Delivery Method and Accessibility

The training program will use a blended instructional model designed to maximize both engagement and accessibility while allowing the program to serve a large number of Independent Facilitators.

Training components that benefit most from discussion, collaboration, and applied practice will be delivered through live sessions offered both in-person and through synchronous virtual instruction**.** These sessions will focus on case analysis, facilitated discussion, and collaborative problem solving related to real-world scenarios encountered by Independent Facilitators, including person-centered planning, spending plan development, and navigation of the regional center review process.

Educational and reference materials that are better suited for independent learning will be provided through on-demand modules delivered through a Learning Management System (LMS)**.** These modules will include policy overviews, explanations of regulatory frameworks, and reference materials related to the Lanterman Act, HCBS requirements, DDS directives, and RCOC service standards.

Participants will retain ongoing access to the LMS following the training, allowing them to review materials and refresh their knowledge as new situations arise in their work as Independent Facilitators.

This structure also supports an efficient approach to language access. Core didactic modules housed in the LMS can be translated once and made available in multiple languages, including Vietnamese and Korean**,** reducing the need for repeated live interpretation while ensuring meaningful access to training content. Live interpretation

will continue to be provided when feasible for interactive sessions where real-time discussion is essential.

8. Language Access
The IABA Research and Education Foundation has a longstanding commitment to linguistic accessibility and culturally responsive training. All training materials and written resources developed for this project will be available in both English and Spanish, and Spanish-language facilitation will be supported by members of the training team, including faculty who are native Spanish speakers.

To support broader accessibility, the training program will use a blended delivery model that includes a Learning Management System (LMS). Core didactic modules delivered through the LMS can be translated once and made available in additional languages, including Vietnamese and Korean**,** which reduces ongoing interpretation costs while ensuring meaningful access to training materials.

Live interpretation for Korean and Vietnamese will be provided for synchronous sessions when feasible, particularly during interactive components of the training that benefit from real-time discussion.

In addition to the training modules, the project will include a monthly Self-Determination newsletter designed to share practical guidance, resources, and updates for Independent Facilitators. Because the newsletter is distributed electronically, it can be translated into multiple additional languages, expanding access to communities in Orange County who speak languages such as Chinese, Farsi, Tagalog, Mandarin, Arabic, and Japanese. Together, these strategies allow the project to meet required language access standards while expanding the availability of training resources to linguistically diverse communities.

9. Participation Capacity
The training program is designed to support both meaningful engagement and broad access for Independent Facilitators serving the Regional Center of Orange County catchment area.

Interactive training sessions will be structured to allow discussion, case analysis, and collaborative problem solving. When demand exceeds the capacity of a single cohort, additional sessions can be scheduled to ensure that all interested participants have the opportunity to attend. Based on the proposed training structure, we anticipate being able to meet training demand within the project period.

In addition to live instruction, core didactic material will be delivered through on-demand modules available through a Learning Management System. Access to these modules will not be capped, allowing participants to review materials and revisit training content as needed. This approach allows the program to maintain high-quality interactive learning environments while ensuring broad access to foundational training content.

Project Budget

Project: Advanced Training for Independent Facilitators
Applicant: IABA Research & Education Foundation
Funding Requested: $20,000 (Not to Exceed)

Budget Category	Description	Amount
Curriculum Development	Development and refinement of training curriculum aligned with RCOC SDP requirements, including person-centered planning modules, SDP budgeting, advocacy, and regulatory frameworks.	$4,500
Translation of Training Materials	Translation of core training materials and written resources into Spanish; translation of LMS modules and selected materials into additional languages (e.g., Vietnamese and Korean).	$3,000
Learning Management System (LMS) Development & Hosting	Development of on-demand training modules, LMS setup, technical support, and participant access management.	$3,000
Training Delivery (Facilitation)	Preparation and facilitation of live training sessions (in-person and synchronous virtual), including case-based instruction and interactive activities.	$6,000
Interpretation Services	Live interpretation for training sessions when needed, including Korean and Vietnamese interpretation for interactive sessions.	$1,500
Program Evaluation & Reporting	Participant feedback collection, analysis of training outcomes, and preparation of a final summary report for the SDP LVAC and RCOC.	$1,500
Project Coordination & Administration	Project coordination, scheduling of cohorts, participant communication, and coordination of training logistics.	$500

Total Project Budget: $20,000

References

California Department of Developmental Services. (2023). *Guidelines for the use of restraint or containment in enhanced behavioral supports homes*. https://www.dds.ca.gov

Doody, C. (2009). Multi-element behaviour support as a model for the delivery of a human rights-based approach for working with people with intellectual disabilities and behaviours that challenge. *British Journal of Learning Disabilities, 37*(4), 293–299.

Mount, B. (2000). *Person-centered planning: Finding directions for change using personal futures planning*. Capacity Works.